Charter Schools Update

Charter Board Committee Meeting

PORTLAND Public Schools

June 23, 2025

Multiple Pathways To Graduation (MPG):

…Where EVERY student is welcome, wanted and worthy

Charter Schools Agenda

Charter Schools Mission and Role of Authorizer

Overview – Charter Schools

Charter School Demographics

Questions

Public Comment

Charter Schools Mission

The mission of the PPS Charter Schools office is to:

- support and monitor a high performing and innovative PPS charter school portfolio
- promote equity and learning for all students
- advocate and act as a liaison for the District in its role as a charter school authorizer with PPS charter schools
- to educate the charter schools, parents, stakeholders, community partners and the District about Oregon charter school statutes and best practices

Charter Schools - Role of Authorizer

District Responsibilities:

- Review and approval or denial of annual applicants for the establishment of new PPS charter schools
- Conducting ongoing oversight and annual evaluation of PPS Charter schools
- Determining whether schools meet expected outcomes to recommend charter renewal
- Implementing interventions for under-performing schools
- Passing through State School Funding
- Creating conditions that improve student outcomes while protecting schools' statutory autonomy
- Maintaining a respectful, mutually- beneficial relationship with school leaders and boards of directors
- Providing resources, professional development, and cost-neutral assistance
- Providing access to information systems and data
- Serving as conduit between district and schools through communication, advocacy, and partnership
- Developing knowledge of schools through frequent informal visits

Charter School Overview

The Charter Schools Office, located within Multiple Pathways to Graduation, provides support to the 1800 PPS students attending the 5 PPS Sponsored and 2 State Sponsored Charter schools.

- Compliance with ORS 338 - Oregon Public Charter Schools statutes
- Oversight and support includes a Weekly Charter Directors Meeting
- Completion of initial application review, contract renewals and annual reporting
- Support and accountability of annual fiscal, operational and academic reports
- School Site Visits

Charter School Overview

Seven Charter Schools are located within PPS Boundaries

Five PPS Sponsored Charter Schools (1,293 students)

- K-5
  - The Emerson School
  - KairosPDX Learning Academy
  - Portland Arthur Academy
- K-8
  - Le Monde French Immersion
  - Portland Village School

Two State-Sponsored Charter Schools, both K-8 (475 students)

  - Cottonwood School of Civics and Science
  - The Ivy School

Charter School Overview

SCHOOL	MODEL	GRADES	OPEN DATE	CONTRACT LENGTH	CURRENT ENROLLMENT	FACILITY STATUS
KairosPDX	Eliminate racial achievement gap	K-5	2014	July 2020-June 2030	205	Lease PPS building
Le Monde French Immersion	French Immersion	K-8	2012	July 2023-June 2033	376	Stable lease -SE Portland
Portland Arthur Academy	Direct instruction	K-5	2005	July 2021-June 2031	162	Stable lease -SE Portland
Portland Village School	Waldorf inspired	K-8	2007	July 2020-June 2030	421	Purchased building 2024. SW Waterfront
The Emerson School	The Project Approach/ Positive Discipline	K-5	2003	July 2019-June 2029	130	Built out new school 2023-24. 15 year lease with 5 year option. Downtown
Cottonwood School	Place based learning	K-8	ODE	State sponsored	~200	State sponsored
Ivy School	Montessori	K-8	ODE	State sponsored	~275	State sponsored

Charter School Overview

Emerson School (PPS Sponsored)

- **K-5 Project-based Learning**
- Enrollment 130
- Move to new Downtown Portland location completed successfully January, 2024; 15yr lease with additional 5yr option
- 2023-24 OSAS scores show 62% of Emerson students meet or exceed in ELA which exceeds District ELA scores by 5% for students in grades 3-5. 56% of Emerson students meet or exceed in Math which exceeds District scores by 3% for students in grades 3-5.
- Additional assessments: Guided Reading Running Records, Lucy Calkins Writing, Bridges Math end of unit, project rubrics

Charter School Overview

KairosPDX (PPS Sponsored)

- **K-5 Eliminating racial opportunity and achievement gaps; anti-racist, culturally affirming education**
- Enrollment 205
- New School leader, Principal, Timothy Rodgers, started in December 2024 - previous Model school exp.
  - Prior to Principal Rogers Kairos experienced multiple school leaders over the last two years
- 2023-24 OSAS data shows that while Kairos underperforms the District in ELA (35.4% meet or exceed) and Math (23.2% meet or exceed) for students in grades 3-5, students of historically underserved races (the majority of KairosPDX student population) compare favorably to District students of historically underserved races. Black students at Kairos outperform the District in ELA for grades 3-5 by 3% (20% at Kairos meet or exceed) and Black students align with the District in Math in grades 3-5 (12% meet or exceed).
- Kairos has qualified for Title 1 target intervention program for 2024-25
- Additional assessments: MAP, Fountas and Pinnell benchmarks,
- Located in NE Portland, Humboldt Elementary

Charter School Overview

Le Monde French Immersion (PPS Sponsored)

- **K-8 French Language immersion, IB World School, IB Primary Years Program**
- Enrollment 376
- 2023-24 OSAS data shows Le Monde students in grades 3-5 outperform the District by 22% (79% of students meet or exceed) in ELA and outperform the district by 22% (75% of students meet or exceed) in Math. In grades 6-8, Le Monde students outperform the district by 34% (89% of students meet or exceed) in ELA and outperform the district by 31% (75% of students meet or exceed) in Math.
- Of note, 100% of Le Monde graduates meet high school language credit requirements prior to starting 9th grade
- Additional assessments: MAP, Dibels, Idapel
- Located in inner Southeast Portland

Charter School Overview

Portland Arthur Academy (PPS Sponsored)

- **K-5 Direct Instruction**
- Enrollment 162
- 2023-24 State assessment data shows 70% of PAA students meet or exceed in ELA which exceeds District scores by 13% for students in grades 3-5. 50% of PAA students meet or exceed in Math which trails the District by 3% for students in grades 3-5. Math is a targeted area of improvement for PAA in 2025-26.
- Over 20% of PAA students are English Language Learners. 2023-24 OSAS data shows PAA English Language Learners exceeded District English Language Learners by 42.9% (ELA) and by 16.8% (Math) in grades 3-5.
- PAA has qualified for Title 1 target intervention program for 2024-25
- Additional assessments: EasyCBM, Mastery Learning DI program assessments
- Located in Southeast Portland

Charter School Overview

Portland Village School (PPS Sponsored)

- **K-8 Waldorf-inspired, standards-based education**
- Enrollment 421
- School purchased new facility on South Waterfront with the assistance of Oregon Facilities Authority; received occupancy and opened school in September 2024.
- 2023-24 State assessment data released shows progress toward improvement. The school shows a 7% increase in ELA scores (from 49% to 56% of students meeting or exceeding) and a 5% increase in Math scores (from 42% to 47% of students meeting or exceeding) over 2022-23 assessment data.
- Additional assessments: EasyCBM, Bridges Math end of unit, MidSchoolMath end of unit

Charter School Overview

State-Sponsored Charter Schools

District provides Special Education services and passthrough of state funds (SSF and SIA) while the ODE provides oversight for these schools. General Education students are not included in PPS Synergy (Student Information System) so are not counted in PPS numbers; Special Education students are included in PPS Special Education numbers.

Charter School Overview

Cottonwood School of Science and Civics (State Sponsored)

- **K-8 Place-Based Education**
- Enrollment ~200
- Located in SW Waterfront area

The Ivy School (State Sponsored)

- **K-8 Montessori Model**
- Enrollment ~275
- Located in North Portland

Charter School Demographics (October 1, 2024)

Charter School	Enrollment	Direct Certification		SpEd		Multilingual Learner		Historically Underserved		Black		Latino		Native American		Pacific Islander		Multi-Race	
	#	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%	#	%
Emerson	130	31	23.8%	29	22.3%	5	3.8%	33	25.4%	4	3.1%	20	15.4%	n/a	n/a	n/a	n/a	9	6.9%
Kairos	226	93	41.2%	25	11.1%	5	2.2%	207	91.6%	137	60.6%	26	11.5%	1	0.4%	2	0.9%	41	18.1%
Le Monde	376	37	9.8%	36	9.6%	2	0.5%	54	14.4%	11	2.9%	21	5.6%	1	0.3%	n/a	n/a	21	5.6%
PAA	166	57	34.3%	22	13.3%	36	21.7%	43	25.9%	20	12.0%	17	10.2%	1	0.6%	n/a	n/a	5	3.0%
PVS	408	100	24.5%	65	15.9%	15	3.7%	82	20.1%	8	2.0%	50	12.3%	2	0.5%	n/a	n/a	22	5.4%
PPS K-5	19,582	6,376	32.6%	3,530	18%	2,453	12.5%	6,865	35.1%	1,549	7.9%	3,686	18.8%	102	0.5%	151	0.8%	1377	7%
PPS Middle Schools	7,356	2,443	33.2%	1,250	17%	705	9.6%	2,467	33.5%	555	7.5%	1,352	18.4%	29	0.4%	55	0.7%	476	6.5%

PPS Enrollment of Underserved Groups Report

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Questions?

